3. MECHANICAL OR ELECTRICAL FAILURE

The Boeing 787 Dreamliner is a most modern flying machine, but it is not immune to mechanical failure. Hydraulics, flight controls or airplane electronics issues, especially during takeoff, leave pilots with the slimmest of margins





TAKEOFF
1:38 PM; cleared for takeoff, the Dreamliner starts taxiing after final preflight checks

MAYDAY CALL
Issued shortly after takeoff, before losing communication

FUEL LOAD
100,000 LITRES of aviation turbine fuel (ATF)

ALTITUDE REACHED
625 FT

DISTANCE TRAVELLED About 2.5 KM



4. HUMAN ERROR

- Aircraft stability experts seem less inclined towards this, saying the airplane was clearly in a nose-low attitude, suggestive of power loss, rather than misjudged control inputs. Capt. Sumeet Sabharwal had 8,200 hours of flying experience in 787 Dreamliners alone in his three-decade-plus career
- Only after the flight data, black box and cockpit voice recorders (CVR) are decoded can anything be said with certainty. For now, the weight of suspicion has settled on the plane's engines and external environmental factors

230
TOTAL PASSENGERS
169 Indians and 61 foreign nationals

12
TOTAL CREW MEMBERS
These included Capt. Sumeet Sabharwal and First Officer Clive Kundar